18?s=20. I am grateful to Sanjiv Shankaran for providing a detailed perspective on the GDP numbers.

22. On unemployment, in September 2020, the Central government's own data estimates are based on the annual Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) conducted by the National Statistical Office (NSO), Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation and the Employment & Unemployment Survey conducted by the Labour Bureau. These surveys showed unemployment rate as follows: 2018-19: 5.8 per cent, 2017-18: 6 per cent, 2015-16: 3.7 per cent, 2013-14: 3.4 per cent, 2012-13: 4 per cent. Details from Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Labour and Employment Santosh Gangwar's reply to Lok Sabha on 14 September 2020 to Unstarred Question No. 214.

23. CMIE data, reproduced here: https://pollniti.com/data/unemployment.html.

24. For more on the social and economic shifts that changed American politics and led to Donald Trump's presidency, see, for example, J.D. Vance, *Hillbilly Elegy: A Memoir of a Family and a Culture in Crisis* (New York: HarperCollins, 2016) and Arlie Russell Hochschild, *Strangers in Their Own Land: Anger and Mourning on the American Right* (New York: The New Press, 2016). Also see the arguments explored by American historian Thomas Frank in his *What's The Matter with Kansas*? *How Conservatives Won the Heart of America* (New York: Metropolitan Books, 2004).

25. Congress, 'Bhakt ka chashma', 9 May 2019. Full video is available at: https://twitter.com/INCIndia/status/1126313591030706176?s=20.

26. See Nalin Mehta, interview with Bruce Stokes, director of Global Attitudes, Pew Research Centre, '8 in 10 Indians have a favourable view of Modi … 50% were critical of his Pakistan policy before Kashmir unrest', *The Times of India*, 30 September 2016, https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/blogs/academic-interest/8-in-10-indians-have-a-favourable-view-of-modi-50-were-critical-of-his-pakistan-policy-before-kashmir-unrest/.

27. After the second wave of the pandemic in early 2021, these consumer perception numbers in the RBI survey dropped